

Dongfang Zhao, Ph.D.

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Education

University of Washington, Seattle	Computer Science, PostDoc	2017
Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago	Computer Science, PhD	2015
Emory University, Atlanta, GA	Computer Science, MS	2008
Katholieke Universiteit Leuven, Belgium	Statistics, Diploma	2005

Employment

2023–present	Faculty, University of Washington ◦ Adjunct Assistant Professor, Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering ◦ Affiliate Faculty of Data Science, eScience Institute ◦ Tenure-track Assistant Professor, Tacoma School of Engineering & Technology
2018–2023	Affiliate Faculty, University of California, Davis
2018–2023	Tenure-track Assistant Professor, University of Nevada, Reno (UNR)
2015	Research Intern, IBM Almaden Research Center, San Jose, CA
2014	Research Intern, Argonne National Laboratory, Chicago, IL
2013	Research Intern, Pacific Northwest National Laboratory, Seattle, WA
2009–2011	Software Developer (full-time), Epic Systems Corporation, Madison, WI

Awards

2022	Federal Research Grant, UNR PI, NSF 2112345, \$255,916 “A DLT Machine Learning Platform for Blockchain Warehousing”
2020	Federal Research Grant, UNR PI, DOE SC0020455, \$200,000 “HPChain: Energy-Efficient Scalable Blockchains for HPC Systems”
2019	Best Paper Award, International Conference on Cloud Computing “BlockLite: Toward Accurate and Efficient Emulation of Public Blockchains in the Cloud”
2018	Best Student Paper Award, IEEE International Conference on Cloud Computing “Toward Cost-Effective Memory Scaling in Clouds: Symbiosis of Virtual and Physical Memory”

Recent Projects

Kaimosia	Intelligence offloading framework enabling offline, server-grade LLM inference on resource-constrained edge devices: https://github.com/hpdc/Kaimosia (private) <i>Tags:</i> on-device AI, small language models, offline inference, AI infrastructure, Python
AdaDisk	Distributed agentic system for adaptive ingestion-query scheduling of DiskANN in LLM serving: https://github.com/hpdc/DiskANN <i>Tags:</i> large language models, agentic systems, distributed computing, C++, Python
Hermes	MySQL plug-in for high-performance homomorphic encryption of vector databases in RAG: https://github.com/hpdc/hermes <i>Tags:</i> retrieval-augmented generation, vector databases, homomorphic encryption, C++

Selected Publications (Dongfang Zhao was/is the *student's academic advisor)

- [1] *Chengyu Gong, *Gefei Shen, Luanzheng Guo, Nathan Tallent, **Dongfang Zhao**. Order-Preserving Dimension Reduction for Multimodal Semantic Embedding. The 40th Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2026.
- [2] *Jiuzhou Fu, Luanzheng Guo, Nathan Tallent, **Dongfang Zhao**. ProHD: Projection-Based Hausdorff Distance Approximation. IEEE International Conference on Data Mining (ICDM), 2025.
- [3] *Jiayao Wang, ..., **Dongfang Zhao**. IPBA: Imperceptible Perturbation Backdoor Attack in Federated Self-Supervised Learning. European Conference on Artificial Intelligence (ECAI), 2025.
- [4] *Gefei Shen, **Dongfang Zhao**. Towards Nonparametric Topological Layers in Neural Networks. The 28th Pacific-Asia Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (PAKDD), 2024.
- [5] *Olamide Timothy Tawose, Jun Dai, Lei Yang, **Dongfang Zhao**. Toward Efficient Homomorphic Encryption for Outsourced Databases through Parallel Caching. Proceedings of the ACM on Management of Data (SIGMOD), 2023.
- [6] *Abdullah Al-Mamun, **Dongfang Zhao**. ECHAIN: Securing Electronic Device Provenance through Privacy-Preserving Consortium Blockchains. The 53rd Annual IEEE/IFIP International Conference on Dependable Systems and Networks (DSN), 2023.
- [7] *Abdullah Al-Mamun, Haoting Shen, **Dongfang Zhao**. DEAN: A Lightweight and Resource-efficient Blockchain Protocol for Reliable Edge Computing. The 36th IEEE International Symposium on Parallel and Distributed Processing (IPDPS), 2022.
- [8] *Olamide Timothy Tawose, *Bin Li, Lei Yang, Feng Yan, **Dongfang Zhao**. Topological Modeling and Parallelization of Multidimensional Data on Microelectrode Arrays. The 36th IEEE International Symposium on Parallel and Distributed Processing (IPDPS), 2022.
- [9] *Abdullah Al-Mamun, Feng Yan, **Dongfang Zhao**. SciChain: Blockchain-enabled Lightweight and Efficient Data Provenance for Reproducible Scientific Computing. 37th IEEE International Conference on Data Engineering (ICDE), 2021.
- [10] *Abdullah Al-Mamun, Feng Yan, **Dongfang Zhao**. BAASH: lightweight, efficient, and reliable blockchain-as-a-service for HPC systems. The International Conference for High Performance Computing, Networking, Storage and Analysis (SC), 2021.
- [11] *Xinying Wang, *Olamide Timothy Tawose, Feng Yan, **Dongfang Zhao**. HDK: Toward High-Performance Deep-Learning-Based Kirchhoff Analysis. The Thirty-Fourth AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2020.
- [12] Heyang Qin, Syed Zawad, Yanqi Zhou, Lei Yang, **Dongfang Zhao**, Feng Yan. Swift machine learning model serving scheduling: a region based reinforcement learning approach. The International Conf. for High Performance Computing, Networking, Storage and Analysis (SC), 2019.
- [13] Parmita Mehta, Sven Dorkenwald, **Dongfang Zhao**, Tomer Kaftan, Alvin Cheung, Magdalena Balazinska, Ariel Rokem, Andrew J. Connolly, Jacob VanderPlas, Yusra AlSayyad. Comparative Evaluation of Big-Data Systems on Scientific Image Analytics Workloads. VLDB, 2017.
- [14] **Dongfang Zhao**, Ning Liu, Dries Kimpe, Robert B. Ross, Xian-He Sun, Ioan Raicu. Towards Exploring Data-Intensive Scientific Applications at Extreme Scales through Systems and Simulations. IEEE Transactions on Parallel and Distributed Systems (TPDS). 27(6): 1824-1837 (2016).
- [15] **Dongfang Zhao**, Li Yang. Incremental Isometric Embedding of High-Dimensional Data Using Connected Neighborhood Graphs. IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (TPAMI). 31(1): 86-98 (2009).